🏆 Sprint 2 Guidelines

COMP9820 Project

💰🧾 Shared Expense Splitter 🧾💰

🌈 1. Overview

In Sprint 1, every team built the same generic Shared Expense Splitter: groups, expenses, splits, net balances, edit and delete, and history.

Whereas in Sprint 2, your team adapts its Sprint 1 build for one specific scenario (variation). You choose a target user, describe their problem, and write and deliver the user stories that solve it. Your Sprint 1 code is the base each variation extends; no additional code will be supplied.

Alongside the variation, your team introduces a continuous integration (CI) pipeline. Every push and merge request will be built, linted and tested automatically, so that the team can see at a glance whether main still works. As more people change more code, the pipeline becomes the shared safety net that lets the team integrate work with confidence.

By the end of Sprint 2, your team should have a working variation that serves a clearly defined user, a CI pipeline that runs on every merge request, and evidence that the work was planned, tracked, reviewed and integrated as a team.

🐭 2. Sprint 2: Variations & Continuous Integration

With the Shared Expense Splitter generic functionality established, Sprint 2 focuses on improving the generic Shared Expense Splitter web application into a specific defined product following your chosen variation. The team will begin establishing more targeted user stories, use cases, and success criteria that describe what the variation must achieve.

More specifically, below are the goals for Sprint 2:

- You will continue practising Agile software team principles, including collaboration, communication, and shared responsibility.
- The team will translate their new targeted ideas into clear user stories, establish good Git habits through branching, committing, and peer-reviewed merges, and deliver an initial set of new features.
- The team will extend its Sprint 1 Shared Expense Splitter by implementing features for its chosen variation.
- The team will design and set up a CI pipeline in GitLab that runs automatically on merge requests and on main, and use it as part of everyday development.
- By the end of the sprint, the group should have working variation features running, a working CI pipeline, and evidence that the team planned, tracked and reviewed its work.

Below is a suggested weekly planner for Sprint 2:

Week	Tasks
5	Sprint 2 planning: define the target user, personas, use cases and success criteria; write and estimate variation user stories; agree the Sprint Goal; create a Sprint 2 milestone. ≥ 2 team meetings
6	(Flexibility Week: No labs or lectures) Design the CI pipeline; get lint and tests passing in CI; begin implementing variation stories; manage issue board. 0-2 team meetings

Week	Tasks
7	Implement variation stories, with every merge request passing the pipeline before review; add tests for new functionality; manage issue board. ≥ 2 team meetings
8	Sprint 2 demo in lab; sprint retrospective; team report, individual report and peer evaluation (Saturday, 7 November)

We will release instructions to help your team achieve the above goals week by week following the relevant lectures. This is to not overwhelm you with information that has not been taught.

💼 2.1 Variations

In Sprints 2 and 3, each team builds out a variation: the same base application adapted for a specific scenario. Your team chose its variation in the Week 4 lab, and your tutor confirmed it. Please contact your tutor if you do not know which variation you need to do.

Variation 1: Splitting a Restaurant Bill

A one-off settlement made in the two minutes at the end of a shared meal. One person uses one phone, with a paper receipt, no accounts and no saved history. The other variations track a group over time; this one ends when the bill is paid.

Ideas for user stories:

- A diner photographs the receipt, and the app extracts its line items
- Each diner claims their own dishes and drinks
- A shared item, such as an appetiser or a bottle of wine, is divided only among the diners who shared it
- Tip and service charge are applied in proportion to each diner's share, with rounding that keeps the total exact
- The person holding the phone corrects a line item the photo extraction misread
- Each diner sees one amount to pay the person who settled the bill

Variation 2: Share House Running Costs

An open-ended arrangement in which expenses recur month after month, and balances never fully settle. Split rules persist from one month to the next, and the household changes as housemates move in and out.

Ideas for user stories:

- A housemate sets up a recurring expense, such as rent or internet, once
- Each type of expense keeps its own split rule: rent divided unevenly by room, utilities by headcount, groceries equally
- A housemate moves in or out mid-month and that month's costs are adjusted
- Each housemate checks a monthly statement of what they paid and what they owe

Variation 3: Group Travel

A fixed group over a fixed period, with one settlement at the end. One person usually fronts most of the cost, and expenses arise in more than one currency and sometimes without an internet connection.

Ideas for user stories:

- A traveller records an expense in the local currency, with the exchange rate captured at the time of the expense
- The group sets a budget per day or per category and tracks spending against it
- A traveller enters expenses offline and they sync when a connection returns

- The group settles once at the end of the trip

Variation 4: Club or Society Treasury

The question is where the money went, not who owes whom. A committee spends on behalf of members, and the treasurer must account for that spending to members who do not record expenses themselves.

Ideas for user stories:

- The treasurer sets budget lines and tracks spending against each one
- A committee member requests funds, and the spending is approved before it is committed
- Members read a report showing spending by budget line
- The audit trail shows who changed each record and when

Variation 5: Employee Expense Claims

Reimbursement comes from an organisation, not from other members of a group. Each claim is checked against a company policy and approved by a manager, so users have different roles with different permissions.

Ideas for user stories:

- A staff member submits a claim with a photo of the receipt
- A manager approves or rejects the claim, or delegates approval to another manager while away
- The app applies policy rules such as per-diem caps and disallowed categories
- Each claim carries tax and account codes
- Finance staff export approved claims to an accounting package

Variation 6: A Shared Fund with Contributions Up Front

Money is collected before it is spent, as with a group gift, a wedding or a shared holiday house. The app tracks money into a pool and spending out of it, rather than reimbursing someone who has already paid.

Ideas for user stories:

- A contributor pledges an amount, and the app records payments actually received against each pledge
- The organiser sets a target and contributors see a running total
- The organiser spends from the pool and each expense is visible to contributors
- The organiser handles an over-subscribed or under-subscribed fund, including refunds

Variation 7: Usage-Based Cost Sharing

Each person's share is derived from logged usage, not from a split declared when the expense is recorded, as in a carpool or a holiday house shared between families. Balances carry forward as credits instead of being settled in cash.

Ideas for user stories:

- A member logs attendance per carpool trip or usage per holiday-house stay
- The app allocates each cost according to the usage log
- Credits carry forward to later trips or stays instead of being paid out
- Members view a fairness report covering the whole season

While working on your variation, keep the following in mind:

• Do not change any Sprint 1 user stories because of your variation. The Sprint 1 build is the base that your variation extends.

• No additional code will be supplied. Each team writes the user stories for its variation and extends its own Sprint 1 code to implement them.

• Scope carefully. Some ideas need external services (for example, receipt photo extraction or live exchange rates) or real authentication and roles. Discuss scope with your tutor before committing to these stories in your sprint plan.

• Plan for two sprints. Your variation continues into Sprint 3, so choose stories for Sprint 2 that deliver a usable core and leave room for the variation to evolve.

• No two teams in the same lab share a variation. If your team proposed its own variation, it must be approved by your tutor.

🐝 2.2 CI Pipeline

In this Sprint, each team must design and set up a CI pipeline in GitLab. Beyond the listed requirements, the design is your team's decision. Think about which stages your pipeline needs, in what order they should run, how long a run takes, and what a team member should do when it fails.

The pipeline is only useful if the tests it runs are meaningful. Write tests for the variation features you build in Sprint 2, ideally before or alongside the code. Coverage targets and broader quality assurance are assessed in Sprint 3, but a pipeline that already reports coverage in Sprint 2 will make that work easier.

At a minimum, the pipeline must:

- Be defined in a .gitlab-ci.yml file.
- Run automatically on merge requests and on pushes to main.
- Run, at a minimum, your linters and your automated test suite, and fail when either fails.
- Pass on the latest commit on main (by the report deadline).

🐼 2.3 Agile software team practice

🦆 2.3.1 Git practice

- Follow 📝 Git Practice

🦆 2.3.2 Participation and meetings

You are expected to have two team meetings per week (on average) in Weeks 5, 7 and 8; optional in Flexibility Week. You will have project check-ins with your tutor during your Week 7 lab; they are excellent opportunities for your tutor to provide you with both technical and non-technical guidance.

🦆 2.3.3 Peer evaluation

Peer evaluation will open from Week 8 Wednesday until Saturday, 9 pm. The results of the teamwork evaluation will only be visible to your tutors and lecturers. Your team members will NOT be able to see other members' inputs. This is only for tutors to know how your group is working together and to better support your group. Submitting it is mandatory for the Peer evaluation marks, but the results will not have direct impact on other parts of your course marks.

The following criteria will be assessed by your team members at the end of the sprint:

- **Participation**: What was the level of participation in group work, attendance at meetings, making suggestions, taking responsibility for tasks, being in communication with the team?
- **Dependability**: How dependable was this team member in delivering assigned tasks, on time, with expected levels of quality?
- **Team Wellbeing**: How much did this team member contribute to the healthy functioning of the team by communicating with members, coordinating meetings, listening to concerns, facilitating discussion, offering suggestions?
- **Work contribution**: How much did this team member contribute to the development of the project.

🐝 2.4 Planning & stories

The following are guidelines on writing good User Stories for GitLab and the "User Stories, Acceptance Criteria and Points" section of your Team Report.

1. Write User Stories:

- Use "As a... I want... so that..." format
- Make them customer-centric
- Include specific, testable acceptance criteria
- Where stories were split, explain how and why

2. Connect to GitLab:

- Create GitLab issues for each story
- Link stories to your issue board

Remember:

- Quality over quantity
- A few well-written stories with clear discovery process > many poor stories
- Show your thinking, not just the final stories

📋 3. Sprint 2 Assessment

Sprint 2 is assessed through both **team-based** and **individual** components. The assessment focuses not only on what your team builds, but also on how effectively you plan, collaborate, track your work, use Git, and reflect on your contribution throughout the sprint.

The Sprint 2 assessment consists of the following four components:

✅ Sprint 2 Assessment Summary

Component	Weight	Deadline
Demo	10%	Live in your Week 8 lab (Recording due Saturday, 7 November, 9 pm)
Team Report	15%	End of Week 8, Saturday, 7 November, 9 pm
Peer Evaluation	1%	Opens Week 8 Wednesday, closes Saturday, 7 November, 9 pm
Individual Report	4%	End of Week 8, Saturday, 7 November, 9 pm

*Together, these components contribute **30% of the overall course assessment**.*

🎬 3.1 Sprint 2 Demo — 10%

When: your Week 8 scheduled lab. Recording due end of Week 8 (Saturday, 9 pm)
Format: Team presentation conducted live during your scheduled lab
Recording: The demo must be recorded, both audio (spoken) and video (slides/browser)
Submission: Team submission via Moodle (MP4 or a text file with a link to the video shared on UNSW's OneDrive)
Late penalty: 5% per day up to five days

The Sprint 2 demo is your team's opportunity to introduce its variation and show how far the team has taken it. **The emphasis is on a working product that serves a clearly defined user, and on how the team's CI pipeline supports its development process.**

The demo will run within **10–12 minutes**, followed by questions from the tutor and/or peers. **All team members are expected to attend and present; non-attendance without Special Consideration will result in a 0 for the absent student**. Each member should understand the team's work and be prepared to discuss relevant aspects of the project.

For the Sprint 2 demo, your team should be prepared to show:

- Your chosen variation, its target users and the problem it solves for them.
- A working demonstration of the variation features built or evolved during Sprint 2. (Features must be shown through the interface, running from main. Sprint 1 features and template features, including the Notes example, earn no credit, except where a Sprint 1 feature was evolved for the variation.)

- An overview of your CI pipeline strategy: its stages, when it runs and why the team designed it that way, with a recent pipeline run on a merge request.
- Participation from all team members during the presentation and Q&A.

Marking Criteria

- **Variation and target users (2%):** explain the variation, who it is for and the success criteria the team is working towards.
- **Working features (3%):** demonstrate your own Sprint 2 variation features live through the user interface, running from main.
- **CI pipeline strategy (2%):** explain the pipeline's design and show it running on a merge request.
- **Presentation, teamwork and Q&A (3%):** present clearly, with every member able to answer questions about the team's work.

Recording

We require a recording of your live lab demo for cross-marking and special consideration purposes.

If your recording exceeds Moodle file upload limits, please upload your recording to your UNSW OneDrive and then upload to Moodle a text document with a link to the recording. Set the link so anyone at UNSW with the link can view, and check it opens in a private browser window before submitting.

📝 3.2 Sprint 2 Team Report — 15%

Due: end of Week 8, Saturday, 9 pm
Submission: Team submission (usually the Scrum Master) via Moodle (PDF)
Suggested length: Approximately **20** pages (including appendices)
Late penalty: 5% per day up to five days

The Sprint 2 Team Report documents the variation your team chose, how you planned and monitored the sprint, and how you designed and used your CI pipeline.

As in Sprint 1, the report should not simply describe what the team did. Explain how and why decisions were made, and support them with evidence from GitLab (screenshots preferred, GitLab links acceptable).

The Sprint 2 Team Report covers the following areas:

🧭 Chosen Variation, Personas, Use Cases and Success Criteria — 3%

Name the variation your team chose and the target user it serves. Describe the problem the variation solves and why the generic Sprint 1 splitter does not already solve it.

Include one or more personas representing your target users, and the main use cases the variation supports. Then state three to five success criteria for the variation: specific, checkable statements of what the variation must achieve by the end of Sprint 3. Your Sprint 3 report will evaluate what the team delivered against these criteria, so write them with that evaluation in mind.

🗂️ User Stories, Acceptance Criteria and Points — 2%

Include the full text of each Sprint 2 user story, with its GitLab issue number, acceptance criteria and story points (recorded using the point labels on each issue). Identify the Sprint Goal and explain how the selected stories contribute to it and to your success criteria. Where stories were split, explain how and why.

🔁 Sprint Monitoring and Burndown/Velocity chart — 3%

Explain how progress was monitored during Sprint 2, with evidence from the issue board and meetings. Include a velocity chart comparing Sprint 1 and Sprint 2: points committed and points completed in each sprint. A story counts towards velocity only if it was merged into main and met its acceptance criteria by the end of the sprint. Sprint 1 ran for about three weeks and Sprint 2 for three (including Flexibility Week). State each sprint's length when comparing velocity, and explain how you'll adjust for Sprint 3, which is a standard two-week sprint. UNSW's GitLab installation does not generate burndown charts; if you would like to include one, build it from the dates your issues were closed.

As in Sprint 1, the marks are for the interpretation, not the number. Explain how the team used its Sprint 1 velocity when deciding what to commit to, whether that decision was right, and how the team will plan Sprint 3.

🔍 CI Pipeline — 4%

This is the most important part of the report. Describe and justify your team's CI pipeline:

- **Design**: the stages and jobs in your pipeline, what triggers it, the order the jobs run in, and what happens when a job fails. A diagram of the pipeline is recommended.
- **Tools**: the tools and configuration your pipeline uses (for example, GitLab CI, Docker images, linters, test runners and coverage tools) and how they relate to the template's make targets.
- **Rationale**: why the team designed the pipeline this way, the alternatives the team considered, and any trade-offs, such as pipeline run time against thoroughness.
- **Evidence it runs**: screenshots or links showing pipelines running on merge requests and on main, including at least one failing pipeline and how the team responded to it.
- **Impact on the team**: how the pipeline changed the way the team reviewed and merged work during the sprint.

⏱️ Sprint 2 Retrospective and Review of Sprint 1 Things to Try — 3%

Conduct and document a Sprint 2 retrospective. Record who facilitated it and how long it took, and cover what went well, what did not go well, and things to try in Sprint 3. As in Sprint 1, focus on processes rather than deliverables, and explain the "why" behind each item.

In addition, assess each "Things to try" item from your Sprint 1 retrospective: did the team carry it out, did it work, and what evidence shows this? A thing to try that the team did not attempt should be reported honestly, with the reason.

Meeting minutes

Include your Sprint 2 meeting minutes as an appendix, and refer to them in your discussion of sprint monitoring.

🤝 3.3 Sprint 2 Peer Evaluation — 1%

Due: end of Week 8, Saturday, 9 pm.
Submission: Individual submission via Microsoft Forms (link available in Moodle)
Late penalty: *No late submissions allowed!*

Each student must complete a **peer evaluation** for their teammates at the end of Sprint 2. The peer evaluation provides an opportunity to reflect on how effectively each member contributed to the team's work and collaborative environment.

You will be asked to evaluate each teammate in relation to areas including:

- **Participation** — their involvement in team activities and the sprint.
- **Dependability** — whether they could be relied upon to complete agreed responsibilities and communicate with the team.
- **Team wellbeing** — how they contributed to a constructive and supportive team environment.
- **Work contribution** — their contribution towards the team's Sprint 2 work and project development.

Peer evaluation responses are **seen by teaching staff only**. They are used to help teaching staff identify teams that may require additional support and to understand how collaboration is functioning within the group.

The Sprint 2 Peer Evaluation is worth **1%**, with the mark awarded for **on-time submission**. There are **no late submissions** for this component; under the assessment outline, a missed peer evaluation receives zero.

👤 3.4 Sprint 2 Individual Report — 4%

Due: end of Week 8, Saturday, 9 pm
Submission: Individual submission via Moodle
Suggested maximum length: 2 pages (not including screenshots)
Late penalty: 5% per day up to five days

Each student must submit an **individual report** describing and reflecting on their own contribution to Sprint 2. This is separate from the Team Report and should focus specifically on your individual work, responsibilities, participation, and learning during the sprint.

Your contribution should be supported by appropriate evidence. In particular, you should connect your work to relevant **GitLab issues, merge requests, and commits** where applicable. The purpose is to demonstrate what you personally contributed and how that work formed part of the team's Sprint 2 development.

Your individual report should address:

- **Your contribution to Sprint 2:** Describe the work you personally completed and the responsibilities you undertook during the sprint.
- **Evidence of your contribution:** Link your discussion to relevant issues, merge requests, commits, or other appropriate repository evidence.
- **Your Scrum role:** Explain your Scrum role and how you performed the responsibilities associated with that role during Sprint 2.
- **Meeting participation:** Reflect on your participation in team meetings and how you communicated progress, blockers, or upcoming work.
- **Lab checkpoints:** Discuss your participation and contribution during the Week 7 lab check-in.
- **What worked:** Identify aspects of your own approach or the team's process that were effective during Sprint 2.
- **What did not work:** Identify difficulties, limitations, or practices that were less effective.
- **One change for Sprint 3:** Identify one concrete change you intend to make in the next sprint based on your Sprint 2 experience.

The report should be reflective rather than simply a list of completed tasks. You should demonstrate that you can evaluate your own contribution and identify how your development and teamwork practices can be improved in the next sprint.

👀 4. Plagiarism & Academic Misconduct Notice

Your program must be entirely your group's work. Plagiarism detection software may be used to compare all submissions pairwise (including submissions for similar assignments in previous terms), and serious penalties will be applied, including an entry on UNSW's plagiarism register.

- Do not provide or show your project work to any other person, except for your group and the teaching staff of COMP9820.
- Do not copy ideas or code from others outside your group.
- Do not use a publicly accessible repository or allow anyone outside your group to see your code, except for the teaching staff of COMP9820.

If you knowingly provide or show your assignment work to another person for any reason, and work derived from it is submitted, you may be penalized, even if the work was submitted without your knowledge or consent. This may apply even if your work is submitted by a third party unknown to you.

The penalties for such an offence may include negative marks, automatic failure of the course and possibly other academic discipline. Assignment submissions will be examined both automatically and manually for such submissions.

Please refer to the online resources to help you understand what plagiarism is and how it is dealt with at UNSW:

- Academic Integrity and Plagiarism
- UNSW Plagiarism Policy

The course reserves the right to reassess whether you meet course outcomes through a similar assessment under significant suspicion of academic misconduct.

5. Assessment AI Mode: Simple Editing Assistance

In completing this assessment, you are permitted to use standard editing and referencing functions in the software you use to complete your assessment, such as spell-check, grammar-check and reference managers. You must not use any functions that generate or paraphrase passages of text or other media, whether based on your own work or not.

If your Convenor has concerns that your submission contains passages of AI-generated text or media, you may be asked to account for your work. If you are unable to satisfactorily demonstrate your understanding of your submission you may be referred to UNSW Conduct & Integrity Office for investigation for academic misconduct and possible penalties.

For more information on Generative AI and permitted use please see here.

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